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AMERICA



DANGEROUS BY DESIGN

State of the States

Uncover the urgent truths behind America's rising pedestrian fatalities and explore transformative solutions to create safer, more inclusive streets for everyone. Join us in reimagining our roadways—prioritizing people over cars to protect lives.

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DANGEROUS
BY DESIGN 2024
State of the States

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Safe Streets for All

Our **first Dangerous by Design 2024 release took a national and metro-focused look at the crisis of people struck and killed while walking on streets across America**, deaths that have increased by 75 percent since 2010. Black and American Indian/Alaska Native persons, older adults, and people walking in low-income communities are killed at much higher rates. Our current approach to roadway safety is not working.



To continue our exploration into how the design of our streets—designed primarily to move cars quickly at the expense of keeping everyone safe—is connected to this historic increase in pedestrian deaths, we are releasing this addendum looking more closely at state-level trends.

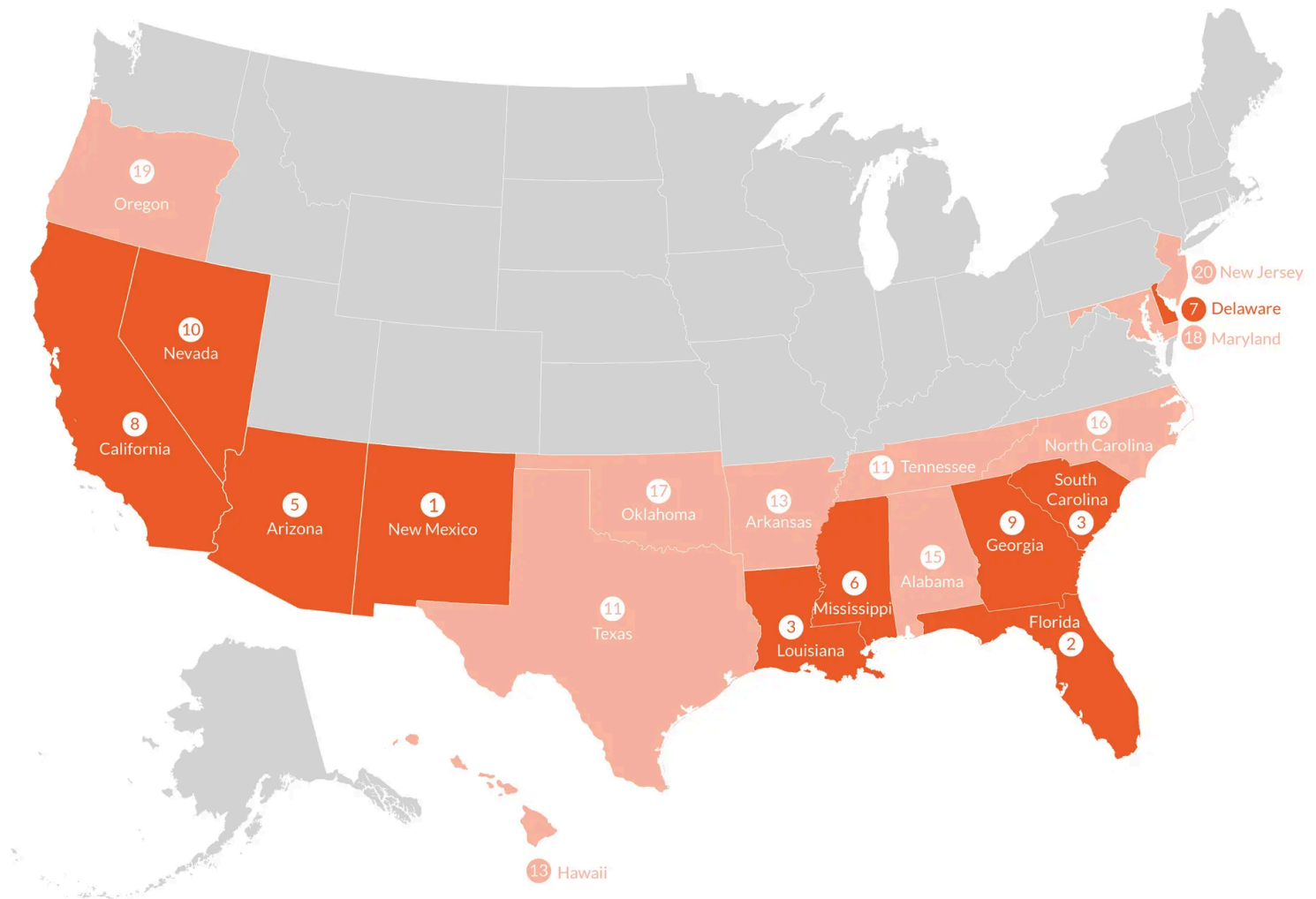


Walking in one of the deadliest states in America



The top 20 most deadly states for people walking

By number of deaths per 100,000 people, 2018-2022



Source: National Highway Traffic Safety Administration. (2024). Fatality Analysis Reporting System.



Design produces danger for all road users

Roads designed to enable high speeds where people and activity are present are the most dangerous type of road. Roadway design influences how people drive, providing nonstop guidance and visual cues that shape behavior and encourage high speeds. Many of the most dangerous roads have multiple wide, straight, high-speed lanes along with other design elements that send powerful, but unconscious, signals to drivers that the street is built primarily for moving vehicles as quickly as possible, even when it's filled with numerous destinations and people walking to them. In addition, these multi-lane roads often have frequent curb cuts and driveways that

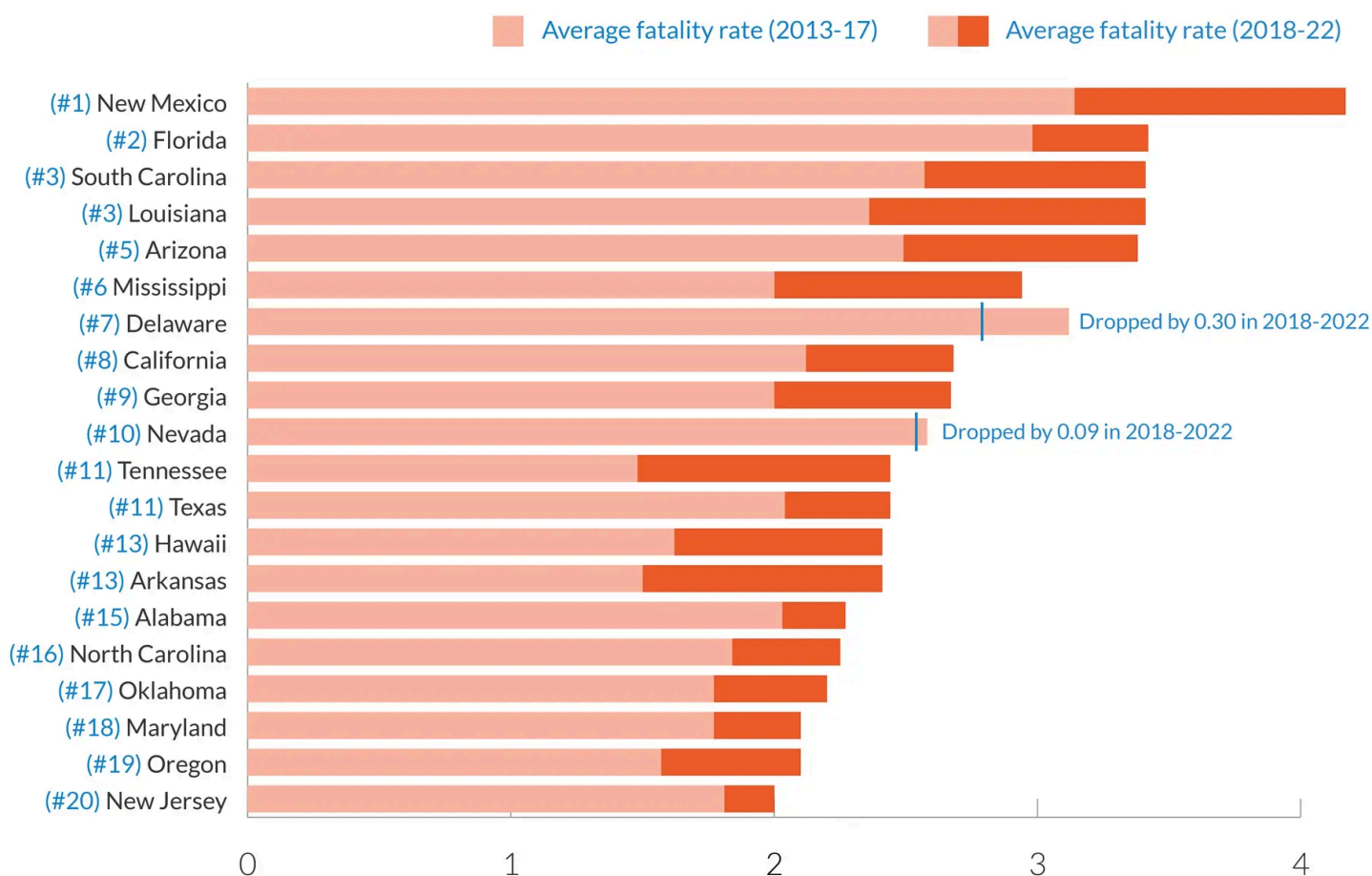


put people walking in harm's way. Many roads lack frequent crosswalks or signals to protect people crossing the street, or safe crossings are missing in the places where people most often want to cross. All of these design elements are focused on improving throughput or prioritizing moving as many vehicles as quickly as possible over the needs of other people using the road, like those walking.



All but two of the top 20 are getting more deadly

The most dangerous states are getting more deadly



*Dangerous by Design 2024 rank in parentheses

Source: National Highway Traffic Safety Administration.
(2024). Fatality Analysis Reporting System.



Despite being designed primarily for moving cars quickly, these streets also serve as neighborhood streets, economic drivers for local commerce, and vital connections to work, school, parks, and more. They move a lot of cars through communities. But in doing so, they create substantial risk for the people who live in these communities who simply want to cross the street to get to a corner store, park, school, or other everyday destinations.

 Good news is that actively designing for slower speeds can produce significant safety benefits, even with minimal impact on traffic delays and congestion.

The data in **Dangerous by Design** continues to demonstrate that the epidemic of preventable deaths and injuries for people walking is getting worse, not better. Using a different approach to street design and funding decisions that prioritizes safety over speed is critical to solving this problem.

*The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention provided support for data analysis and synthesis used in the report under cooperative agreement OT18-1802 supporting the **Active People, Healthy NationSM Initiative**, a national initiative led by the CDC to help 27 million Americans become more physically active by 2027.*

Learn more: <https://www.cdc.gov/physicalactivity/activepeoplehealthynation/index.html>. The findings and conclusions in this report are those of the authors and do not necessarily represent the official position of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

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